

Digital Footprint

Learning Objectives

- Understand what a digital footprint is and how it's created
- Recognize the permanence of online actions and their consequences
- Learn to manage and protect their digital footprint

Engage (5-7 minutes)

When walking on muddy ground, we leave footprints that others can follow. Online, every action leaves a digital footprint — posts, photos, comments, searches — that can be found and followed by others, like footprints in wet earth that tell where we've been.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Students list actions that create digital footprints: social media posts, online searches, app downloads, comments on videos, and email messages. Like a farmer's daily path through fields, each online step leaves a trace that can be followed.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

A digital footprint is the trail of data left by online activities. It includes active footprints (things you intentionally share) and passive footprints (data collected without your knowledge). Like footprints in sand that remain until washed away by waves, digital footprints can last indefinitely on the internet.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Students audit their own digital footprint: what would someone find if they searched their name? They create a plan to manage their footprint positively — sharing good things, avoiding harmful content, and cleaning up old posts. Like a farmer maintaining clean paths for others to follow.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Can students explain what a digital footprint is? Can they identify at least three types of online actions that create footprints? Do they have a plan to manage their digital presence positively?